Winston Li

Updated on Oct 13, 2026.

liwy3@uci.edu • (925) 588-6740 • winstonyli.github.io • winstonyli on GitHub and LinkedIn

Education

UC Irvine • B.S. in Computer Science w/ Honors, 3.9 / 4.0 GPA — Sep 2024 – Jun 2026

- graduated in 2 years • ICS Honors Program • UROP Fellow
- Data Structures • Algorithms • Software Eng. • Operating Systems • Compilers
- Cryptography • Formal Lang. & Automata • Quantum Computation • Distributed Systems

Projects

tatic • *Rust, WebAssembly, dependent type theory* — Mar 2026 – Present

- Built a **JIT** for a higher-order language, caching compiled **WebAssembly** by content hash.
- Gated installation on agreement with an interpreter and a **kernel-checked proof** of the compiler model; unprovable terms stay interpreted.
- Added an independent checker replaying the specializer, and translation validation from the IR.
- Fuzzed the JIT against the interpreter: 1000 seeds × 12 trials, zero mismatches, planted bugs caught.
- Mined rewrite rules from laws the prover couldn't close; seeded libraries needed 3–5× fewer machine proofs (one theory).

Lambast • *Honors research project using Rust* — Feb 2025 – Jun 2026

- Built a whole-program optimizing compiler for untyped λ-calculus using **closure conversion** and **De Bruijn indices**.
- Generated randomized benchmark terms via Grygiel & Lescanne's binary lambda-term enumeration; presented at the **UCI UROP Symposium**.

renno • *Rust* — Sep 2026 – Present

- Built a scripting language on a **CEK machine** with multi-shot **algebraic effect handlers**.
- Added **gradual typing**, run-time checks, effect rows, refinements, length-indexed vectors; 400+ tests.

cereal • *C99* — Sep 2026 – Present

- Wrote a C99/GNU front end in C99: preprocessor, macro lint, parser, checker, **language server**.
- Matched gcc-13 diagnostics on 3,908/3,910 runnable gcc.dg tests; fuzzed parallel `-E` for same output.

Skills and interests

Proficient in Rust, C / C++, JS / TS, Python, Svelte, Tailwind.

Familiar with Git, HTML / CSS, Nix, LaTeX, Typst, Claude Code, Unix systems & shells.

Acquainted with most mainstream languages, e.g., C#, Go, Haskell, Java, Lua, Ruby, SQL.

Research interests ≈ programming language design & theory.

Experience

Learning Assistant • UC Irvine — Mar 2025 – Jun 2026

- Delivered supplementary pedagogy for **Python** and upper-div **Algorithms,** e.g., Master Theorem.
- Spearheaded study sessions to identify and guide students through gaps in understanding.

Intern • LGBTQIA+ Identity Commission @ UC Irvine — Oct 2024 – Jun 2025

- Led a team of 3 to organize and host themed Gayme Show™.

Programmer • Video Game Development Club @ UC Irvine — Sep 2024 – May 2025

- Worked with team of 13 to create typing game in **C#** and **Unity**; led dev of the main UI window.